7 December 2025 — קריאת התורה, קדושה דסידרא, and למנצח מזמור לדוד

Content-based review · reviewer read the transcripts, summary, and finished write-up · 25 October 2026

1.The Shiur in One Paragraph

A Sunday-morning shiur (the *parashah* just read was *Vayishlach*) in the *Seder HaTefillah* series, continuing from the previous week's *Brich Shmei*. It begins with the *aliyah*: why a second blessing after *Birchas HaTorah* (*kavod haTorah*); how the *Gemara* at the end of *Megillah* explains the enactment of a blessing for every *oleh* (*gezeirah mipnei haniknasim vehayotzim*); the lecturer's aside against mocking the title of *Mishnah Halachos*. It then turns, "by the way," to *Birkas HaGomel*: the four categories (*chaim*), the dedication for R' Yossi Zelig, ten and two scholars, the Torah scroll in place of the two, the pearl from *Shalmei Nedarim*, the *Rosh* on reading as an offering, and the question of *Hisorerus Teshuvah* (R' Shimon Sofer of Erlau, the grandson who told of him). After the *Yehi Ratzons* of Monday and Thursday (the lost one censored), it begins *Kedushah DeSidra*: *Ashrei* three times (*Berachos* 4b), the *kavanah* of *Poseiach es Yadecha*, why two at *Shacharis*, the connection to *Kedushah*, Rabbi Akiva Eiger's note, the *Aruch HaShulchan* and the *Mishnah Berurah*, the family tree and the Otisville anecdote, and the *Yesod VeShoresh HaAvodah*. The last third is *Lamnatzeach*: Sura, Rav Natronai Gaon and Lucena (*Elisana*), *Beis Rabbeinu SheBeBavel* and the early *chassidim*, the legend refuted by Rav Hai, the Lucena cemetery and the Nikolsburg fence, the eighteen chapters, and the *Yerushalmi* on blessing a fellow after prayer. It stops mid-topic with the closing *mishnah*.

2.Overall Fidelity

The finished write-up follows the shiur closely and keeps its best moments (the latecomer, the bank account of merits, the prisoners at Otisville, the legend and Rav Hai's reply, the tombstones). It is a good reordering of a discursive talk. Three sources were read: the bilingual Plaud transcript (clearest; it glosses each Hebrew word and is the authority on every disputed point below), the Sofer-style transcript ("Speaker 1"; heavily garbled, e.g. *Eiriz Truva*, "Rav Nachmanoy"), and the AI summary. **No Sofer .docx exists for this date**, so the Sofer .txt was treated as secondary to Plaud. **The pattern is the same as last time: the write-up inherited its misstatements from the summary**, which in places departs from both transcripts (a date in December 2024 and "7 Kislev 5785," a made-up author name for *Shalmei Nedarim*, the *Ketzos HaChoshen* for Rabbi Akiva Eiger, the *Yerushalmi* for the *Mishnah*, "no, no" for *Elisana*). Those, and three errors the editor introduced, are listed below; all were corrected in the finished HTML in the same pass except where marked.

3.Content Flags — Misstatements and Overclaims

Flag 1 — The Hebrew date. The header and colophon gave ז' כ טלו תשפ"ו (the summary has טלו תשפ"ה, December 7, 2024). 7 December 2025 is **י"ז טלו תשפ"ו** (Chanukah begins the evening of 14 December = 24→25 Kislev; the previous week's write-up is dated 10 Kislev for 30 November). The shiur itself gives no Hebrew date. Corrected.

Flag 2 — *Elisana* is not "no, no." The write-up says the *Rishonim* call Lucena סנא, "the Spanish way of saying 'no, no.'" The Plaud transcript is clear: the name is סנה, "because it equals the words of אלי ... קהלי הושענא ועגא, the Spanish way of saying it." The Sofer transcript garbled it ("the Spanish way of saying 'no'"), the summary turned it into "no, no," and the write-up copied the summary. Corrected.

Flag 3 — Rabbi Akiva Eiger, not the *Ketzos HaChoshen*. The callout in Section V says the note in the margins of the *Gemara* is by the *Ketzos HaChoshen*. Plaud: עקיבא איגר בגליון הש"ס, "how do you say *gilyon* in English? On the margin," printed in the Vilna *Shas*. The summary substituted the *Ketzos* (who wrote no *Gilyon HaShas*); the write-up followed and even invented "the *Ketzos HaChoshen*'s own gemara." Corrected; the note itself is not located (see Section 7).

Flag 4 — *Mishnah*, not *Yerushalmi*, for the early pious. Plaud: "the משנה says in חסידים הראשונים היו שוהים שעה אחת, ...ות." The summary says the *Yerushalmi*, and the write-up (body and fn 18) followed, quoting a *Yerushalmi* wording with "an hour before… and an hour after." Checked on Sefaria: Mishnah Berachos 5:1 (an hour before), Berachos 32b (before and after), and Yerushalmi 5:1 (which does speak of an hour after) all exist, so the citation in fn 18 is not wrong; a cross-reference to the *Mishnah* and *Berachos* 32b was added. The body wording was left as is.

Flag 5 — *M'haht gepoilt alles gut*, not "*zol zayn mekubal*." The write-up says that at graves of the righteous one yid says to another זא ' זיין מקובל. Neither transcript has this. Plaud: אט געפועלט אלעס גוט, explained as "whatever you prayed for you should be *poel*, it should come true," with a song sung in Camp Agudah. Corrected in the body and fn 22.

Flag 6 — "Last *Shabbos*" was yesterday. The write-up has "Last ת we shared a beautiful pearl" (Section III). The lecturer says "yesterday there was a wonderful yid over here that spoke by *seudah shlishis*" (and the shiur is on Sunday). To a reader a week later, "last *Shabbos*" is wrong. Corrected to "Yesterday, at ס"דה שלישית.

Flag 7 — Slips of the oral voice. "(You correctly added the parallel…)" is the lecturer thanking a congregant; in print it addresses a nameless "you." Corrected to "A congregant rightly raised." Likewise the Ps. 107:32 quotation was a hybrid of two verses (a refrain plus the verse); Plaud has וירוממוהו בקהל עם ובמושב זקנים לוהו. Corrected. The family reference to the author of *Torah Temimah* lacked the book, ר שאמר, which the lecturer names. Added.

Flag 8 — The count of the chapters of *Tehillim* is reversed. The write-up says "our nineteenth perek is, in the older count, the twentieth," contradicting fn 20 ("our perek 20, originally perek 19") and the sense: with 1 and 2 as one chapter, *Lamnatzeach*, our chapter 20, is the *nineteenth* after the eighteen. The lecturer was himself muddled ("after 18, today after 19"). Corrected to the *Gemara*'s count (checked at Berachos 9b).

Flag 9 — The author of *Shalmei Nedarim*. The recording does not clearly give his name. The Sofer transcript has "Alexander Sender HaKohen **Kaplan**"; the summary has ן, and the write-up (body and fn 8) used the summary's spelling as fact. Left unchanged and flagged: it could not be confirmed either way (not on Sefaria).

4.Content Flags — Omissions

The following were said in the shiur and left out of the write-up. Item 1 is a substantive piece of Torah.

- **The question of *Hisorerus Teshuvah*.** After the *Rosh*, the lecturer introduces R' Shimon Sofer of Erlau (the *Chasam Sofer* → *Ksav Sofer* → R' Shimon), the German Colony community of Erlau in Jerusalem, and the grandson, David Sofer, an antique-Judaica collector, who told him his grandfather was 95, after sixty years in the rabbinate, when he went to Auschwitz and died; the book asks whether one should answer *Amen* to *HaGomel* at all or say only מי שגמלך. The lecturer: "we say both." (Restored in the Sefer Edition, hedged.)
  - The aside from *Menachos* 99b: the *Gemara* says one may not tell the *amei haaretz* that *Kriyas Shema* morning and evening satisfies the obligation to learn, and the link to the three-day reading cycle.
- The explanation of the mockery: *Mishnah Halachos* as a play on כל השונה הלכות.
  - That Sephardim still follow the older practice of the *oleh* reading for

himself (the Plaud line is a congregant's or the lecturer's, *ספרדים still do it*), and that the lecturer himself gave the reading to another the previous day because he had not prepared.

- The Cairo Genizah aside (some 150,000 pages; the coming digitization, an article sent by Shea Kanner) and the Chabad "770" aside on *Beis Rabbeinu SheBeBavel*.
- That *Rav Natronai* is "1100 years ago" and the earliest source after the *Gemara* "until the end of the Geonic era."
- The identification of the earlier *shiur* on *matzevos* (Yaakov's *matzeivah* on Rachel's grave, last *parashah*) that leads into the Lucena cemetery, and who raised the Nikolsburg fence (a congregant).
- The family passage: "Weiss for 400 years until my grandfather changed it to Efrati" and the older brother's research, cut from the write-up (the Sefer Edition keeps it in one sentence).
- The closing: the lecturer ends with *Mishnah Makkos* 3:16 (רבי חנניה בן עקשיא אומר). The write-up ends with a composed sentence instead.

5.Added or Editorial Material Not in the Shiur

The footnotes carry a good deal that the lecturer did not say. Most is background and plausible; some is stated as the lecturer's view.

- **fn 4:** "*Chazal* attribute the original *takkanah* to Moshe at Mei Marah; Ezra reorganized" (the lecturer said Moshe and Ezra in passing). The *Gemara* (BK 82a on Sefaria) says "the prophets among them." Narrowed in the HTML.
- **fn 5, 8, 11, 14, 16:** biographical details (Rav Menashe Klein 1923–2011 and a student of Satmar; the standard *perushim* on *Nedarim*; *Machzor Vitry* "records a tradition" with details; the *Aruch HaShulchan* "over 35 years" and the Netziv as nephew; "ed. Brody,

Yad HaRav Herzog, 1994”). None is in the shiur; none was verifiable on Sefaria. Unchanged and flagged.

- **fn 10, 13, 19:** the *Rosh* “ch. 9” (the offering comparison is not at Rosh Berachos 9:3), “*Mishnah Berurah* 51:16; OC 132” (not retrieved), and the *Rambam* “citing the *Yerushalmi*” (the halakhah cites no source). Hedged or corrected in the HTML.
- **fn 18 and fn 22:** read the *Yerushalmi* as saying exactly what the lecturer said, plus “Verify exact citation” left as a working note. The lecturer said he found it “last night.” On Sefaria, Yerushalmi Berachos 4:4 and 5:1 do not cite Ps. 20:2. Marked unlocated in the HTML.

6.Halachic / Lomdish Observations

- ***HaGomel* at the reading.** The *Gemara* (Berachos 54b, confirmed) requires ten (Abaye, from *bikhal am*) and two sages (Mar Zutra, from *uvemoshav zekeinim*), and Rav Ashi’s objections are left difficult; the *Tur* and *Rosh* (confirmed) follow the stringent view. That the *Sefer Torah* stands for the two sages is the lecturer’s explanation of the custom, not the *Gemara*’s, and should be said as such. (Done in the Sefer Edition.)
- **Three *Ashrei*.** *Berachos* 4b says the psalm earns its place only by combining the alphabetical order with the verse of sustenance (each alone is insufficient: *Tehillim* 119 is alphabetical, the Great *Hallel* mentions sustenance). The write-up (fn 12) says it “gives two reasons”; the lecturer said the same. Worth one sentence of precision in the Sefer Edition (done in the note).
- **The early pious.** The *Mishnah* has the hour *before*; *Berachos* 32b adds the hour after and ties it to *Ashrei yoshvei veisecha*, which is exactly the verse the lecturer cites. The write-up’s emphasis on the *Yerushalmi* is therefore secondary.

- **The lecturer's *Yerushalmi* on *Lamnatzeach*.** Neither Yerushalmi 4:4 nor 5:1 on Sefaria cites *Yaancha Hashem*. The claim that the *Rishonim* read *Lamnatzeach* as a blessing to one's neighbor, "based on the *Yerushalmi*," is the lecturer's and remains unsourced.

7.Follow-up Questions Worth Asking the Rav

Q1.Which *Yerushalmi* (chapter and *halakhah*) says to bless one who finishes praying with *Yaancha Hashem*? Which *Rishonim* read *Lamnatzeach* that way?

Q2.The legend of Rav Natronai's *kefitzas haderech*: was it in Spain, as said, or at Mainz, as commonly told? Where is Rav Hai's reply?

Q3.The author of *Shalmei Nedarim*: Kaplan or Shefelin? What exactly does the introduction say?

Q4.Which *Rosh* compares the reading to an offering and links *HaGomel*?

Q5.Rabbi Akiva Eiger's note on *Berachos* 4b: where, and what does the *Rosh*'s text read?

Q6.The *Hisorerus Teshuvah*: is the question on answering *Amen* there? Was R' Shimon Sofer 95?

Q7.Did Rav move his academy from Nehardea to Sura? Where does the *Lucena* responsum say *Lamnatzeach*?

Q8.The sponsor/dedication: R' Yosef Nachman Zelig, the wedding date, the correct spelling.

8.Bottom Line

A faithful and well-shaped write-up of a discursive shiur. The misstatements came, as before, mostly through the summary (the date, Ketzos HaChoshen, the Yerushalmi, "no, no," the author's name) and, from the editor, a reversed chapter count, a hybrid verse, an invented

> *Yiddish phrase and a “last Shabbos” that was yesterday. Fix those, restore the Hisorerus Teshuvah passage and the closing mishnah, hedge the unsourced footnotes, and the sefer edition can stand. The one substantive point that is the lecturer’s own and not the sources’ is the Yerushalmi on Lamnatzeach; it should be shown as his report until located.*

Produced by a content-based review pass reading the Plaud transcript, the Sofer-style transcript, the AI summary, and the finished write-up (as delivered, before the corrections described above were applied). No Sofer .docx was present for this date.